

laws he breaks, you find yourself getting into serious trouble for things that you did not do.

Information: Most of us are paranoid about our personal information. Most of us don't even like giving out our real e-mail addresses, so someone gaining access to files that you think are private and secure is somewhat of a nightmare come true. An attacker can also gain access to cookies stored on your computer, and also any confidential material such as office documents and trade secrets that are stored on your laptop or desktop. Your online purchases via credit card transactions or Internet banking details and passwords may be accessed by the attacker. If you find yourself poorer by a few thousands all of a sudden, or find that you bought the gadgets you always wanted to have by credit card, you know where to start looking.

File Damage: Some attackers are just malevolent, and have no interest in anything but damaging your computer. These are generally one-off attacks and result with most of your files going missing or being changed. For example, you may find all your word documents deleted, or all text replaced with something along the lines of "MUHAHAHAHAHAHA! You were hacked by Da Hax-Master."

DoS/DDoS: Your Internet connection may be used to launch Denial of Service (DoS) or Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) attacks on the Internet. Hackers use the Wardriving technique to find vulnerable WLANs and then infect the computers with worms or Trojans that they can control via the Internet. These worms or Trojans lie dormant waiting for a signal from the hacker. When a hacker wants to target another computer, he may use your computer to hack into another, or just launch a huge DDoS attack against his victim, using your computer and thousands of others similar to yours which are online at that moment.